



Caravans (convoys) of pack animals—from camels, horses, and mules, to yaks, llamas, and even elephants—have been used throughout history to transport food, materials, and goods for trade. Camels are famed for their ability to withstand heat and a lack of water, making them perfect for cargo-carrying trips across hot deserts. This route across

Ethiopia, from Danakil to the trading center of Mekele, involves a 60-mile (100-km) trek across one of the hottest places on Earth, with temperatures soaring past 122°F (50°C). Salt caravans have crossed the Sahara for more than 2,000 years. In the past, thousands of animals made up the camel trains, but today 20 to 30 are more common.